The Wild Swans at Coole W. B. Yeats- poem

1. Read the following lines from The Wild Swans at Coole and answer the questions that follow

The trees are in their autumn beauty,
The woodland paths are dry,
Under the October twilight the water
Mirrors a still sky;
Upon the brimming water among the stones
Are nine-and-fifty swans.

The nineteenth autumn has come upon me
Since I first made my count;
I saw, before I had well finished,
All suddenly mount
And scatter wheeling in great broken rings
Upon their clamorous wings.

I have looked upon those brilliant creatures,
And now my heart is sore.
All's changed since I, hearing at twilight

1. What does the poet observe about the sky and the water in the first stanza?

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2. Which of the following details accurately describe the setting and count in the poem?

A. The season described is autumn.

B. The poet counts exactly fifty-nine swans.

C. The scene takes place during a bright summer morning.

D. The poet has been visiting this place for nineteen years.

Choose the correct option:

(a) Only A and B

(b) Only B and C

(c) Only A, B, and D

(d) All four statements

3. What happens when the poet tries to finish counting the swans?

4. Which of the following statements are TRUE according to the passage?

A. The woodland paths are muddy and wet.

B. The poet feels a sense of sadness or "soreness" in his heart.

C. The swans are described as "brilliant creatures."

D. Everything has remained exactly the same since the poet's first visit.

Choose the correct option:

(a) Only B and C

(b) Only A and D

(c) Only A, B, and C

(d) All four statements

5.Pick out a pair of rhyming words from the stanza

2. Read the following lines from The Wild Swans at Coole and answer the questions that follow

The first time on this shore,

The bell-beat of their wings above my head,

Trod with a lighter tread.

Unwearied still, lover by lover,

They paddle in the cold

Companionable streams or climb the air;

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Their hearts have not grown old;

Passion or conquest, wander where they will,

Attend upon them still.

But now they drift on the still water,

Mysterious, beautiful;

Among what rushes will they build,

By what lake's edge or pool

Delight men's eyes when I awake some day

To find they have flown away?

1. How does the poet's physical state during his first visit contrast with his current state?

2. Which of the following phrases describe the nature and condition of the swans?

A. Their hearts have not grown old.

B. They are "unwearied still" as they paddle.

C. They have become tired of the "companionable streams."

D. Passion and conquest still attend upon them.

Choose the correct option:

(a) Only A and C

(b) Only B and D

(c) Only A, B, and D

(d) All four statements

3. What does the poet wonder about the future of the swans?

4. Which of the following statements are TRUE according to the passage?

A. The poet describes the sound of the swans' wings as a "bell-beat."

B. The swans always swim alone and avoid each other's company.

C. The poet previously walked with a "lighter tread" than he does now.

D. The water is described as turbulent and noisy at the end of the poem.

Choose the correct option:

(a) Only A and B

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(b) Only A and C

(c) Only C and D

(d) All four statements

5. ‘Unwearied still, lover by lover’. Commend on the figure of speech used in the line

answers

ANSWERS

SET 1

1. The water is so still that it acts like a mirror for the sky.

2.(c) (C is incorrect; it is October twilight)

3.(c) (A is incorrect; they "mount" and "scatter")

4.(a) (A is false—paths are dry; D is false—"All's changed")

5.dry-sky, stones -swan

SET 2

1.When the poet first visited, he "trod with a lighter tread," implying he was younger, more energetic, and less burdened by life compared to his current state.

2.(c) (C is incorrect; they paddle in "companionable" streams).

3.(a) (B is incorrect—their hearts don't grow old; D is not mentioned).

4.(b) (B is false—they are "lover by lover"; D is false—water is "still").

5.Personificaton

APPRECIATION

THE WILD SWANS AT COOLE -W. B YEATS

W.B. Yeats, one of the most celebrated poets of the 20th century, is renowned for his lyrical poetry that intricately weaves themes of nature, love, and the complexities of human emotions. His work often captures a delicate balance of beauty and melancholy, inviting the reader to ponder profound philosophical thoughts. “The Wild Swans at Coole” stands out as a significant piece, embodying Yeats’ deep admiration for the natural world while reflecting on the relentless passage of time and the inevitable transformations that accompany it. Through this poem, Yeats expresses a poignant exploration of ageing and the bittersweet nature of life's

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fleeting moments alongside the enduring beauty of the world around us.
In the poem, Yeats describes visiting Coole Park, where he sees a group of sixty wild swans swimming gracefully on the lake. He marvels at their majesty, freedom, and eternal beauty, which contrasts with his own ageing and mortality. The poet notices that although the swans remain unchanged, he himself feels the effects of time, realising that life is fleeting and full of change. He compares the swans' lively, eternal nature with the temporary joys and sorrows of human life. The poem ends with a melancholic reflection that life is transient, yet the beauty of nature remains a source of inspiration and comfort.

Yeats skillfully employs a variety of poetic devices to enhance the richness of the poem. Vivid imagery brings the scene to life, allowing readers to visualise the swans with lines such as "their hearts have not grown old" and "their heads are bent gracefully," fostering an emotional connection with their timeless beauty. Symbolism plays a crucial role, with the swans representing not just eternal grace but also the passage of time—a reminder of life's impermanence. The use of alliteration and assonance contributes to the poem's musicality, creating a lyrical flow that immerses readers in the enchantment of the natural world. Additionally, the contrast between the changing life and the unchanging beauty of nature makes the poem more thoughtful.

In my opinion, I find "The Wild Swans at Coole" a thought-provoking work. It invites us to not only appreciate the wonder of nature but also to confront our own lives and the transient nature of our experiences. Yeats uses simple but very meaningful language. This makes the poem easy to understand and also touches our feelings.
The poem shows the lasting beauty of nature and the short life of human beings. It reminds us to enjoy nature and value every moment of our lives.

LANGUAGE ELEMENTS

I. Fill in the blanks with the right phrasal verbs from the brackets

1. I had (1) _____ _____ only on the traditional accounts of the nesting habits of birds. These were interesting enough for a keen bird photographer, as I was, to want to (2) _____

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_____ on film. But while (3) _____ _____ in a canvas hide, perched high up on a stepladder, a few yards away from the nests, I noticed some unusual goings on which clearly showed that the birds had not followed the rules (4) _____ _____ in the textbooks.

2. We soon introduced ourselves. He was an Austrian anthropologist, Baron Omar Rolf. He claimed ornithology to be his second love and (1) _____ _____ great keenness on accompanying me the next morning. Led by a forest guard, we were (2) _____ _____ a narrow animal trail through dense tall grassland (3) _____ _____ five feet high – the right kind of habitat for the Broad-tailed Grass Warbler to (4) _____ _____.

II. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from those given in brackets.\

(along, of, my, of, the)

1. Orinthology may sometimes entail hazards --------(a) a different kind. I recall one particularly hair-raising incident ----------(b) the Himalayan trail ----------(c) Almora to ----------(d) Lipu Lekh Pass on --------(e) way to Lake Manasarovar and Mount Kailas in 1945.

2. The huge dam and reservoir has now completely submerged Parambikulam and all the lovely country (1) _____ it. We reached Parambikulam just as it was getting dark. (2) _____ the verandah (3) _____ the forest bungalow, I found a large group (4) _____ Kadar adivasis, and (5) _____ their midst, a bare-footed 'topless' European male (6) _____ crumpled khaki shorts.

III. Edit the following passage.

1, Upon turning a bend in(a) the path, the forest guard suddenly ducked, excitedly pointing at(b) front. I just glimpsed the head of a tusker striding down the same path from the opposite direction, and turned to flee as fastly(c) as I could, motioned(d) to Omar, who were(e) ten yards behind me, to done(f) likewise.

2. In the verandah on(a) the forest bungalow, I finded(b) a large group of Kadar adivasis, and in their(c) midst, a bare-footed 'topless' European male in crumpled khaki shorts. He had(d) an Austrian anthropologist, Baron Omar Rolf. He claimed ornithology to being(e) his second love and expressed great keenness on accompany(f) me the next morning.

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IV. Complete the dialogue suitably.

1. King : The hermit father is there, ----a---------?

Hermit girl : No, he is not there .

King : ----------b----------?

Hermit girl : He has gone to Somatirtha.

King : Whom shall I meet here?

Hermit girl : You would better ------c----------.

King : Who is his daughter?

Hermit girl : Shakuntala. If you come with me,----d---King. :
Sure. I will come with you. -------e----------?

Hermit girl : yes, she will see your devotion and report it to the sage.

2. Complete the dialogue suitably.

Narrator: You are an anthropologist, ---------a---------?

Baron Omar Rolf: Yes, but ornithology is my second love.

Narrator: ----------b----------?

Baron Omar Rolf: I am very keen on accompanying you tomorrow morning.

Narrator: The grass is five feet high. If we follow the forest guard, ---------c---------.

Baron Omar Rolf: I don't mind the difficult trail. ---------d---------?

Narrator: We are looking for the Broad-tailed Grass Warbler.

Baron Omar Rolf: If we are lucky enough to spot it, ---------e---------?

Narrator: Yes, I will definitely record it on my film.

V. Read the given dialogue and complete the sentences given below:

1. King : How shall I meet Shakuntala ?

Hermit girl : You can come with me and meet her.

King asked the hermit girl ----------a----------

Hermit girl replied ----------b----------

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2. Report the following dialogue.

KING :- Is the hermit father there?

THE TWO HERMITS :- No, he has left his daughter to welcome the guests and has just gone to Somatirtha.

a)What did the King ask ?

B)What was the hermits' reply?

VI. Pick out the Noun Phrase in the subject position and Verb phrase in the sentence that follows.

1. The path he takes is strewed.
2. The hermit girls watered the young trees.
3. One of the standard questions to me is about the thrilling adventures in a life time of exploring birds.
4. The field study of birds is a peaceful occupation.
5. The huge dam and reservoir have now completely submerged Parambikulam and all the lovely country around it.

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Answer Key

SET I .1

1. Grown up
2. Set down (or Put down)
3. Tucked away (or Hid away)

Laid down (or Set out)

SET I.2

1. Put across (or Spoke of)
2. Heading along (or Cutting through)
3. Coming up
4. Show up (or Hide out)

SET II.1

a. of, b. along, c. from, d. the, e. My

SET II.2

1. Around 2. In (or On) 3. Of 4. Of 5. In 6. in

SET III.1

Answer Key

(a) of (b) in (c) fast (d) motioning (e) was (f) do

SET III.2

(a) of (b) found (c) there (or their) (d) was (e) be (f) accompanying

SET IV.1

Answers : a. isn't he?

b. Where has he gone?

c. see his daughter.

d. you can meet her. / I will show her to you.

e. Will she see my devotion and report it to the sage?

SET IV.2

Answers

a. aren't you

b. Would you like to join me on my trek

c. Will you come with mecwe will be able to find the habitat

d. we can find the birddWhich bird are we stalking

e. What is our targetewill you take a photograph

f. will you record it

SET V.1

a) King asked the hermit girl how he should meet Shakuntala.

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b) Hermit girl replied that he could go with her and meet her.

SET V.2

a. The King asked if the hermit father was there.

b. The two hermits replied that he was not there and added that he had left his daughter to welcome the guests and had just gone to Somatirtha.

SET VI

Noun Phrase	Verb phrase
1. The path he takes	Is strewed.
2. The hermit girls	Watered the young trees.
3. One of the standard questions to me	is about the thrilling adventures in a life time of exploring birds.
4. The field study of birds	Is a peaceful occupation.
5. The huge dam and reservoir	Have now completely submerged Parambikulam and all the lovely country around it.

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